

Q1. Answer the following:

(i) Which are the two main climatic factors responsible for soil formation?

Ans. Temperature and rainfall are the two main climatic factors responsible for soil formation.

(ii) Write any two reasons for land degradation today.

Ans. Deforestation and the indiscriminate use of chemical pesticides and fertilizers in agricultural lands are two factors contributing to land degradation.

(iii) Why is land considered an important resource?

Ans. Land is among the most important natural resources. It provides habitation to a wide variety of flora and fauna. Human beings use land for various purposes such as agriculture, forestry, mining, building houses and roads, and setting up industries.

(iv) Name any two steps that government has taken to conserve plants and animals.

Ans. Two steps that the government has taken to conserve plants and animals:

(a) Government has set up national parks, wildlife sanctuaries and biosphere reserves for protecting natural vegetation and wildlife.

(b) Government has banned the killing of lions, tigers, deer, great Indian bustards and peacocks.

(v) Suggest three ways to conserve water.

Ans. Three ways to conserve water:

(a) Rain-water harvesting.

(b) Reducing wastage of water.

(c) Replenishing ground water by promoting afforestation

Q2. Tick the correct answer.

Do it yourself.

Q3. Match the following.

Do it yourself.

Q4. State whether the given statements are true or false. If true, write the reasons.

(i) Ganga–Brahmaputra plain of India is an overpopulated region.

Ans. This statement is true. Plains and river valleys offer suitable land for agriculture. Hence, these are densely-populated areas of the world.

(ii) Water availability per person in India is declining.

Ans. This statement is true. Though water is present in abundance, fresh water is a scarce resource. Due to the wastage of water, deforestation, and the pollution of fresh water reserves (such as rivers and ground water), the availability of water is fast declining.

(iii) Rows of trees planted in the coastal areas to check the wind movement is called intercropping.

Ans. This statement is false. The described process is called shelter belts.

(iv) Human interference and changes of climate can maintain the ecosystem.

Ans. This statement is false. Human interferences and climatic changes adversely affect the balance of the ecosystem.